Ropivacaine 0.75%

Mechanism of action

- Ropivacaine is a local anaesthetic. It blocks the initiation and transmission of nerve impulses by blocking the movement of sodium ions across the nerve cell membrane.

Authorised practice levels

- ICPs and CCPs.

Indications

- ✓ Severe pain associated with clinically obvious fractured neck of femur or fractured proximal shaft of femur, where pain has not been adequately controlled with an opiate and transport time (including extrication time) to hospital is greater than 30 minutes.

Contraindications

- ✕ Known severe allergy.
- ✕ Local infection at the site of injection.
- ✕ Additionally, for fascia iliaca block:
  - » Previous surgery in the groin.
  - » Aged less than 12 years.

Cautions

- ⚠ Taking an anticoagulant.

Use in pregnancy or when breastfeeding

- Safe and may be administered if indicated.

Dosage

- 40 ml of 0.375% (20 ml of 0.75% diluted to 40 ml) ropivacaine for an adult weighing greater than 60 kg.
- 30 ml of 0.375% (15 ml of 0.75% diluted to 30 ml) ropivacaine for an adult weighing 60 kg or less.

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- Administer the fascia iliaca block once only.

Administration

- Administer the dose described into the fascia iliaca space.

Common adverse effects

- Stinging at the time of injection.

Usual onset of effect

- 5-10 minutes.

Usual duration of effect

- 1-2 hours.

Usual preparation

- Ampoule containing 150 mg in 20 ml (0.75%).

Pharmacokinetics

- Ropivacaine is metabolised in the liver.
- There are no significant effects from liver impairment on acute administration.

Common interactions

- None.

Additional information

- A fascia iliaca block may be performed if the patient is taking antiplatelet medicines such as aspirin, clopidogrel or ticagrelor.

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- A fascia iliaca block may be performed if the patient is taking an anticoagulant but have a low threshold for stopping the procedure if it is difficult, and do not attempt multiple passes with the needle.
- Overdose of ropivacaine is very rare but can occur if doses exceed 150 mg in an adult or it is inadvertently administered IV. If this occurs the following may develop:
  - Tingling around the mouth.
  - Seizures.
  - Dysrhythmias, particularly bradydysrhythmias.
  - Hypotension.
  - Cardiac arrest.

More Information

Version history

22 November 2022 1.0.1

Update: Aligned with analgesia CPG.